

At the same time, we have to produce the required doctors, nurses and paramedical personnel. In this context, the Government's move to give permission to big hospitals to start medical colleges is welcome.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

Fire Warning

It is high time the municipal corporations and fire departments in metro cities take fire control seriously ("Wake up Call", April 12). Preventing undue modifications in pre-existing structures, providing for adequate number of fire extinguishers and fire exits in buildings and educating citizens through mass media channels are the key points in battling fire hazards.

PUNEET MADHOK,
Bhavnagar

The Big B Row

Whatever explanation Amitabh Bachchan may offer, he should not forget that Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi will use his association with the state's tourism to boost his image ("Paa to Pariah", April 12). Since Bachchan has become the brand ambassador of the Gujarat Government, the demand that the superstar clarify his stand on Modi's actions post-Godhra cannot be ignored.

S.N. VERMA,
Lucknow

Amitabh Bachchan's ostracism by the Congress party goes beyond his being the brand ambassador for Gujarat tourism. If Modi is so untouchable, then what will happen if electoral arithmetic catapults him into the prime ministerial slot? In such a scenario, will some Congressmen threaten to shave off their heads?

BISHAN SAHAI,
via www.indiatoday.in

of pride among all ranks, especially the senior officers, is commendable.
LT-COL (RETD) RANJIT SINHA,
Kochi

Justice at Last

The judgement in the rarest of rare case of honour killing, comprising capital sentence for the convicts who killed an innocent couple at the behest of Khap Panchayat, reflects the cast-iron



GETTY IMAGES

The IPL has not only taken cricket to a new level in the country, it has also helped the market of sports business in India grow. Other sports federations should try to emulate the IPL model.

ROHIT BHANDIYE, *Panaji*

Force Multiplier

Kudos to the new army chief for his soldier-like vision ("General on a Tough Turf", April 12). General Vijay Kumar Singh's wish that he, along with modernising the weapons and equipment of the army, must also revive the age-old ethos and imbibe a sense

resolve of the judiciary to ensure the supremacy of law of the land ("Honourable Justice" April 12). Since the Haryana Government has abdicated its responsibility to fight inhumane diktats, the responsibility shifts to the Centre. Evidently, the judgement is exemplary.
INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

Victim of Passion?

In an unprecedented case, a Sessions Judge at Pune, L.G. Deshpande, sentenced a 22-year-old student Parvez Shaikh to death last month for the murder of Digambar Divekar. The alleged motive: Divekar refused to have homosexual relations with Shaikh. Though the sentence is subject to the confirmation of the high court, it was the first time that a death sentence had been passed because, as the Judge put it, of the "cancerous growth of the carnal desires" of an accused. "Persons like the accused are nothing but wild beasts and have no place in society," the judge said in his announcement, the severity of which has shocked a large part of the community. The murder took place on May 30, 1979 in room No. 16 of a Telco Institute hostel where Divekar was staying. The hostel was virtually empty that particular day because of a holiday. Shaikh, who lived in room No. 13, had entered Divekar's room a little before 11 p.m. armed with a knife.

by Hoshi Lal



DIGAMBAR
DIVEKAR

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